

Unit - 5 : Interview

5.1 Interview Techniques & Interview Preparation

Meaning of Interview

An interview is a formal and purposeful conversation between an interviewer and a candidate to assess the candidate's knowledge, skills, personality, attitude and suitability for a particular job or opportunity. It is not just a question-answer session, but a two-way communication process. The interviewer learns about you, and you also get a chance to know more about the organization and the job role.



"An interview is an opportunity to show who you are, not just what you know."

Importance of Interview Techniques

- Helps in creating a positive first impression.
- Builds confidence and reduces nervousness.
- Helps in presenting your thoughts in a clear and organized way.
- Shows your communication and interpersonal skills.
- Increases the chances of selection.
- Helps you handle difficult questions and real-life situations.
- Demonstrates your problem-solving and decision-making abilities.

Key Points to Remember :

- Be punctual
- Dress appropriately
- Be confident and polite
- Maintain good body language
- Listen carefully
- Answer honestly
- Show interest in the organization
- Ask relevant questions

Preparing for an Interview

1. Research about the Organization - Know about the company's mission, vision, products/services, recent news and work culture.
2. Understand the Job Role - Read the job description carefully and match your skills with the requirements.
3. Prepare Your Documents - Keep your updated resume, educational certificates, identity proof and other relevant documents ready.
4. Practice Common Questions - Prepare answers for commonly asked questions like "Tell me about yourself", "Why should we hire you?" etc.
5. Improve Communication Skills - Speak clearly, use correct language and avoid filler words like "um" or "you know".
6. Work on Your Body Language - Maintain eye contact, sit properly, smile and show confidence.
7. Be Mentally Prepared - Stay calm, positive and be yourself.
8. Plan Your Journey - Know the interview venue, time and route in advance to avoid last-minute problems.

Do's and Don'ts

Do's ✓

- Be honest
- Show enthusiasm
- Use positive language
- Listen carefully
- Ask questions
- Thank the interviewer

Don'ts ✗

- Don't be late
- Don't give false information
- Don't speak negatively about previous employers
- Don't interrupt
- Don't use mobile phone
- Don't be overconfident

Conclusion

Proper interview techniques and preparation can make a big difference in your success. With the right attitude, good communication and thorough preparation, you can face the interview with confidence and perform well.



Golden Tips :

- ★ Know yourself
- ★ Stay updated
- ★ Be confident
- ★ Learn from every interview
- ★ Turn every interview into a learning experience

5.2 Interview Formats

An interview can be conducted in different formats depending on the purpose, profile, number of candidates and the organization's hiring process. Each format has its own features, advantages and is suitable for specific situations. Knowing the different interview formats helps you understand what to expect and prepare accordingly.

1. **One-to-One Interview** : A single interviewer conducts the interview. It allows for in-depth discussion and is the most common format.
2. **Panel Interview** : A group of interviewers (usually 2 or more) ask questions. It is used for senior positions and provides multiple perspectives.
3. **Group Interview** : Multiple candidates are interviewed together. It helps the employer assess communication, leadership and teamwork skills.
4. **Telephonic Interview** : Conducted over a phone call. It is usually the initial screening round to shortlist candidates.
5. **Video Interview** : Conducted through online platforms like Zoom, Google Meet, etc. It is widely used for remote hiring.
6. **Stress Interview** : The interviewer deliberately creates a stressful environment to test the candidate's patience and response.

Common Interview Formats (Visual View)



One-to-One



Panel



Group



Telephonic



Video



Stress

"Different formats, but the same goal – to find the right talent."

5.3 Types of Interview Questions

In an interview, different types of questions are asked to assess a candidate's knowledge, skills, attitude, experience and overall suitability for the job. Being aware of these types helps you prepare better and answer confidently.

1. **General Questions** : These are basic questions about you, such as "Tell me about yourself" or "Why do you want to work here?".
2. **Behavioral Questions** : These questions assess your past experiences and behavior. Example – "Can you describe a time when you faced a challenge and how you handled it?".
3. **Technical Questions** : These are job-specific questions to test your subject knowledge and practical skills.
4. **Situational Questions** : These questions present a hypothetical situation to see how you would react. Example – "What would you do if...?".
5. **Case Study Questions** : Mostly used in management and analytical roles. You are given a problem or case and asked to find a solution.
6. **HR Questions** : These questions focus on your personality, strengths, weaknesses, career goals and cultural fit.
7. **Brain Teaser Questions** : These are logical or tricky questions to check your problem-solving ability.
8. **Closing Questions** : At the end, you may be asked if you have any questions for the interviewer.

Examples of Questions

- Tell me about yourself.
- What are your strengths and weaknesses?
- Why should we hire you?
- Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
- How do you handle pressure?
- Do you have any questions for us?

Tips to Answer Effectively

- ☒ Be honest and confident
- ☒ Give clear and structured answers
- ☒ Use real examples
- ☒ Stay positive
- ☒ Listen carefully to the question
- ☒ Avoid irrelevant information

"Prepare well, answer smartly, and make a lasting impression."

5.4 Mock Interviews

Meaning

A mock interview is a simulated interview session that helps you practice for a real job interview. It is usually conducted by a teacher, mentor, career counselor or a peer, who acts as an interviewer and asks questions similar to those asked in actual interviews. The main purpose of a mock interview is to give you a real interview experience in a safe and supportive environment so that you can identify your strengths and weaknesses and improve your performance before the final interview.

How Mock Interviews are Conducted?

1. The interviewer asks questions based on your resume, skills, experience and general knowledge.
2. The session may be conducted in person, online (video call) or in a group setting.
3. You are expected to answer the questions just like a real interview.
4. After the session, you receive feedback on your performance, including your strengths, areas for improvement and suggestions.
5. You can practice multiple times to gain confidence and improve your answers.

5.5 Benefits of Mock Interviews

1. **Builds Confidence** - Regular practice helps you feel more confident and reduces nervousness during the actual interview.
2. **Improves Communication Skills** - You learn to express your thoughts clearly and effectively.
3. **Helps Identify Weaknesses** - You get constructive feedback and can work on your weak areas.
4. **Familiarizes You with Interview Process** - You understand the interview environment, types of questions and time management.
5. **Enhances Problem-Solving Skills** - You learn to think quickly and give better answers in challenging situations.
6. **Increases Chances of Success** - With proper practice and preparation, you perform better in the real interview and improve your chances of selection.

Mock interviews turn nervousness into confidence and practice into success."



"Practice today for a better tomorrow!"



Common Mock Interview Questions

- Tell me about yourself.
- Why do you want to work in this field?
- What are your strengths and weaknesses?
- Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
- Why should we hire you?
- Can you describe a challenge you faced and how you handled it?
- Do you have any questions for us?

Tips for a Successful Mock Interview

- ✓ Prepare well before the session.
- ✓ Dress formally, just like a real interview.
- ✓ Be honest and natural in your answers.
- ✓ Listen carefully to the questions.
- ✓ Maintain good body language (eye contact, posture, smile).
- ✓ Take feedback positively and work on it.
- ✓ Practice regularly with different people.
- ✓ Try to answer within the given time.
- ✓ Ask for suggestions at the end.

